The actors in the Pa-O community

Despite organizational name changes, the Pa-O national movement remained united until 1973 when the Shanland Nationalities Liberation Front (SNLF) separated from the main group, which at that time was called the Shan State Nationalities Liberation Organization (SSNLO), because the latter was increasingly influenced by communist ideology. Through several more splits and amalgamations, the SNLF eventually became PNO as it is known today (the nationalist Pa-O), and SSNLO became today's Pa-O National Liberation Organization (PNLO) (the communist Pa-O) (Callahan 2007; Charney 2009; Christensen and Sann Kyaw 2006; Keenan 2012; Lintner 1999; Sakhong and Keenan 2014; Smith 1999) (for details and stages of change, see Figure 5. 1).

Figure 5.1. The evolution of the PNO and the PNLO

